

1. Before you can import an XML document, you need to have one you can use. You can copy the following code and save it as an XML document labelled “colors.xml”:

- `<?xml version="1.0" encoding="UTF-8"?>`
- `<palette>`
- `<color>Orange</color>`
- `<color>Red</color>`
- `<color>Yellow</color>`
- `</palette>`

2. Create a new Flash AS3 movie and save it to the same folder as the XML document.
3. Create a new object to manage the XML:

- `varmyXml:XML;`

4. Now create a new URLLoader file that will load the XML file:

- `varxmlLoader = new URLLoader();`
- `xmlLoader.addEventListener(Event.COMPLETE,onXMLLoaded);`
- `xmlLoader.load(new URLRequest("colors.xml"));`

5. At this point you have loaded the XML successfully into Flash. You can test this by adding the following function to trace the contents of the XML document into your Outputwindow.

- `functiononXMLLoaded(e:Event):void{`
- `myXml = new XML(e.target.data);`
- `trace(myXml);`
- `}`

6. The result should look just like your XML document.
7. You can now easily pull out a specific value. For instance, add the following to the onXMLLoaded function to extract the third value in the XML file:

- `trace(myXml..color[2]);`

The double dots after the variable myXML allow you to step to the second value of your XML document. All of this is so much easier to accomplish with E4X than with the AS2 version.

Regular expressions

Patterns are everywhere as you develop your code. This is clearly seen with the use of regular expressions, a method for describing the pattern of data you are looking to use. Using regular expressions, you can now easily format form fields to correctly capture date, ZIP, or credit card numbers. You can use a simple pattern with a string variable to validate the data: